

Cover Letters / Job Application Content Creation

| Beyond OSU: Career Readiness

Assignment Overview:

Cover letters are meant to connect your skills, experiences, interests and/or values to the position and organization to which you are applying. The most compelling and competitive cover letters demonstrate a strong alignment between the candidate and the position.

NOTE: Sometimes (more frequently these days), a cover letter may not be asked for. However, the content you create for a cover letter is also critical content that can go directly into an application. So, although the format of this assignment is talking about cover letters, know that this is more about crafting responses for a specific job.

Instructions:

Step 1: Identify a position or job posting.

To complete this worksheet, find an existing position or job posting and fill out the chart on page 2 based on the information in the position description and information you can find on the company website or social media.

What is the title of the job you chose: Assembly Engineering Intern

What organization or company is it for: Mercedes-Benz Vans, LLC

Step 2: Turn those phrases into sentences.

After completing page two of this worksheet, and using your results from column 2, you'll write 6-8 sentences highlighting the skills and experiences that best connect you with the points listed in the position description and company website/social media.

These are draft sentences, so content connection and keywords are the most important elements.

You'll then use those sentences to build a cover letter specific to that job.

Tip: Lead with your experience using keywords from the position listing (example: specific software skills, team player, detail-oriented, good communicator). ATS (Applicant tracking software – AI systems and hiring teams) will scan your application for key words at larger firms, so use them in your cover letter and resume. After you list your experience bring it back to **why** you would be a great fit for this position. This process also highlights your focus on details, research and company knowledge.

Student Worksheet:

Job Title: Assembly Engineering Intern	
Job Description	How I match
LIST 3 TRAITS SOUGHT IN A CANDIDATE Examples: Strong interpersonal skills.	WRITE 3 PHRASES DESCRIBING YOU Examples: Strong communicator, interpersonal skills.
1) Eager, Driven and focused.	1) Extremely motivated towards engineering
2) He or she should be willing to learn and be taught skills from experienced members of the engineering team.	2) Curious of interworks, want to understand the component of each project.
3) The individual should be self-motivated and interested in adding value and making a difference within an organization.	3) Results oriented with
LIST 3 JOB DUTIES/RESPONSIBILITIES Examples: Collect field samples, track vitals, assist clients.	WRITE YOUR ACHIEVEMENT THAT MATCHES EACH DUTY Examples: Capstone project involved collecting weekly samples, tracked patient vitals every 2 hours, assisted customers at my job.
1) Process documentation.	1) Previous internship experience involved me communicating with multiple clients. I effectively managed these clients through separate folders, maintaining code based upon client and project.
2) Read and interpret drawings.	2) Used geotechnical report drawings to infer soil conditions for future foundation locations. Used data with fad tools to design structures up to 105 feet above ground level.
3) Project planning using Microsoft planner.	3) Updated calendar to have all in office information: typical work hours, meeting availability, etc....
LIST 3 FACTS OR TRAITS ABOUT THE COMPANY Examples: Provides holistic approach to housing, LEED certified, ranked #1 in customer satisfaction, innovative.	LIST STORIES OR EXAMPLES THAT CONNECT WITH THOSE FACTS Examples: Shared value of holistic counseling, interned with green building firm, was the employee of the month, highly creative.
1) Sole Vans manufacturing plant for Mercedes-Benz that is located withing the united states.	1) With most of the manufacturing being done overseas these days, being able to be part of a facility that is able to keep the manufacturing withing the US aligns well with my career goals.
2) Mercedes-Benz Vans, LLC has invested more than 500 million U.S. Dollars in the new Sprinter plant, which officially opened in 2018.	2) This heavy investment shows a stable company, meaning this position will have help for job security.
3) MBV Charleston was selected to be the first plant in the Mercedes-Benz Vans global production network to produce the all-new sprinter, beginning in 2024.	3) As a student with an extreme interest in sustainability, the electric vehicle manufacturing at this plant is extremely enticing to me.

Student Worksheet (continued):

Step 2: After completing page two of this worksheet, and using your results from column 2, write 6-8 sentences below highlighting the skills and experiences that best connect you with the points listed in the position description and company website/social media.

Tip: Lead with your experience using keywords from the position listing (example: specific software skills, team player, detail-oriented, good communicator). ATS (Applicant tracking software – AI systems and hiring teams) will scan your application for key words at larger firms, so use them in your cover letter and resume. After you list your experience bring it back to **why** you would be a great fit for this position. This process also highlights your focus on details, research and company knowledge.

6-8 sentences here:

- I worked extensively with PLS CAD and FADD tools to read and interpret geotechnical drawings, using soil condition data to design foundations for steel poles up to 105ft tall.
- I managed multiple client projects simultaneously by maintaining organized documentation folders with project and client specific codes, demonstrating strong process documentation skills.
- I gained experience with project planning tools, updating calendars to track work hours, meeting availability, and project deadlines to keep teams coordinated and informed.
- With most manufacturing moving overseas, being part of a facility that maintains domestic production at the sole U.S. Mercedes-Benz Vans plant aligns perfectly with my career goals.
- I am particularly excited that MBV Charleston was chosen to be the first plant in the global production network to produce the new electric Sprinter beginning in 2024.
- As a student with strong interest in sustainability, contributing to electric vehicle manufacturing represents exactly the kind of meaningful work I am pursuing in my engineering career.
- My practical experience in technical drawing interpretation and process documentation from Power Engineers has prepared me to contribute effectively to assembly engineering operations.
- I am eager to apply my technical knowledge to support manufacturing excellence at a facility that represents American manufacturing while advancing electric vehicle technology.

Turn your above sentences into a Cover Letter

Build three segments into your letter. 1) Introduction, who you are and why you are interested in the position. 2) Main Body: Match the main position requirements to your skills and experiences. What is your strongest sentence above? Then add a few more of your sentences to strengthen why you fit and what you bring to the company and culture (2-3 paragraphs). The more you understand about the job and place, the more you can tailor it! 3) Closing: Wrap up final thoughts, thank them, and let them know you are excited to speak more about this position. Please write your cover letter below.

[A Career Development Center cover letter checklist can help guide you through the process.](#)

01/15/2025

Hiring Manager Mercedes-Benz Vans, LLC Charleston, SC

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Assembly Engineering Intern position at Mercedes-Benz Vans, LLC. Graduating with my Mechanical Engineering degree from Oregon State University in June 2026, I am eager to contribute to a facility that represents American manufacturing while also helping advance electric vehicle technology.

My internship at Power Engineers gave me practical experience in process documentation and technical drawing interpretation. I worked extensively with PLS CAD and FADD tools to read and interpret geotechnical drawings, using soil condition data to design foundations for steel poles up to 105ft tall. I managed multiple client projects simultaneously by maintaining organized documentation folders with project and client specific codes. I also gained experience with project planning tools, updating calendars to track work hours, meeting availability, and project deadlines to keep teams coordinated and informed.

What draws me to Mercedes-Benz Vans is the opportunity to work at the sole U.S. manufacturing plant for Mercedes Benz Vans. With most manufacturing moving overseas, being part of a facility that maintains domestic production aligns perfectly with my career goals. I am particularly excited that MBV Charleston was selected as the first plant in the global production network to produce the new electric Sprinter beginning in 2024. As a student with strong interest in sustainability, contributing to electric vehicle manufacturing represents exactly the kind of meaningful work I am pursuing in my engineering career.

I have included my resume for your consideration and would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute to the assembly engineering team at MBV Charleston. Please feel free to contact me at M.brady2214@gmail.com or 503-979-1369.

Sincerely,

Matthew Brady